

Abigail Fuesler

abigail.fuesler@umontana.edu | abigailfuesler.com | Missoula, MT | 805-464-3736

Education

Doctor of Philosophy, Forest and Conservation Sciences

Expected 2028

University of Montana

Missoula, MT

Dissertation: *Emergent norms and authenticity: Cycling towards understanding the social construction of outdoor adventure sport*

Graduate Certificate, Women's, Gender, and Sexuality Studies

2028

University of Montana

Missoula, MT

Master of Science, Experiential and Outdoor Education

2024

Western Carolina University

Cullowhee, NC

Thesis: *The life significance of undergraduate outdoor academic programs: Alumni perspectives*

Bachelor of Arts, Integrated Studies

2019

Brevard College

Brevard, NC

Wilderness Leadership & Experiential Education and Business & Organizational Leadership

Environmental Studies Minor

Gender Studies and Leadership Minor

Refereed Publications

- **Fuesler, A.**, Bobilya, A. J., Daniel, B., & Hobbs, W. (In review). The impact of outdoor academic program coursework on career development. *Journal of Outdoor Recreation, Education, and Leadership*.
 - Rice, W. L., Armatas, C. A., & **Fuesler, A.** (In review). Do wilderness visitors see paying fees as stewardship?: The mediating role of transparency on fee support. *Journal of Leisure Research*.
 - **Fuesler, A.** & Rice, W. L. (2025). Dry and outside: The rise of sober outdoor recreation experiences. *Leisure Sciences*. 1-10. <https://dx.doi.org/10.1080/01490400.2025.2563810>
 - Rice, W. L., Phillips, K. E., Armatas, C. A., Pitas, N. A., Zou, S., & **Fuesler, A.** (2025). A systematic review of visitor preferences concerning recreation allocation. *Socio-Ecological Practice Research*. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s42532-025-00216-1>
 - **Fuesler, A.**, Bobilya, A. J., Daniel, B., & Hobbs, W. (2025). Alumni perspectives of the life significance of attending an undergraduate outdoor academic program. *Journal of Outdoor Recreation, Education, and Leadership*. <https://doi.org/10.18666/JOREL-2025-12571>
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Editor-Reviewed Publications

- **Fuesler, A.** & Johnson, H.A. (In review). Future directions for allocation research within U.S. public lands management. *Parks Stewardship Forum*.
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Technical Reports

- **Fuesler, A.**, Rice, W.L., and Ross, T. (2026). *Marshall Mountain Summer Season Visitor Use and E-Bike Sentiment Study*. Technical Report. Missoula, MT: University of Montana, Wildland and Recreation Management Research Laboratory. https://scholarworks.umt.edu/soccon_pubs/43/

- **Fuesler, A.**, Rice, W.L., Armatas, C.A., and Johnson, H.A. (2026). *Alpine Lakes Wilderness Recreation Allocation Study*. Technical Report. Missoula, MT: University of Montana, Wildland and Recreation Management Research Laboratory. <https://research.fs.usda.gov/treearch/80472>
- **Fuesler, A.**, Rice, W.L., Armatas, C.A., Phillips, K.E., and Omolara, P. (2025). *Palomar Ranger District Recreation Allocation Study*. Technical Report. Missoula, MT: University of Montana, Wildland and Recreation Management Research Laboratory. <https://research.fs.usda.gov/treearch/80206>

Refereed Archived Datasets

- **Fuesler, A.**, Armatas, C.A., and Rice, W.L. (In review). *Palomar Ranger District in the Cleveland National Forest: Visitor survey data from 2025*. Fort Collins, CO: Forest Service Research Data Archive.
- **Fuesler, A.**, Armatas, C.A., and Rice, W.L. (In review). *Alpine Lakes Wilderness in the Okanogan-Wenatchee National Forest: Visitor survey data from 2025*. Fort Collins, CO: Forest Service Research Data Archive.

Non-Refereed Publications

- **Fuesler, A.** (2020). Best friends forever thanks to camp. *Camping Magazine*. <https://www.acacamps.org/article/camping-magazine/best-friends-forever-thanks-camp>

Refereed Conference Presentations

- **Fuesler, A.**, Rice, W. L., Armatas, C. A., & Pan, B. (In review). *Communitas and crowding in wildland recreation*. To be presented at The Academy of Leisure Sciences, February 10-12, 2027. Salt Lake City, Utah, USA.
- Pan, B., Rice, W. L., Armatas, C. A., **Fuesler, A.**, & Omolara, P. (Accepted). *Beyond crowding: Monitoring pro-social outcomes of wilderness recreation experiences across space and time*. To be presented at the International Conference on Monitoring and Management of Visitors in Recreational and Protected Areas, November 3-6, 2026. València, ESP.
- Rice, W. L., Armatas, C. A., **Fuesler, A.**, Omolara, P., & Pan, B. (Accepted). *Communitas, crowding, and a new paradigm in visitor experience: Evidence from two National Forests*. To be presented at the George Wright Society ParkForum, October 19-22, 2026. Knoxville, Tennessee, USA.
- Rice, W. L., **Fuesler, A.**, Armatas, C.A., & Johnson, H.J. (2026). *Is paying a fee an act of stewardship? Transparency as a missing link to wilderness visitor support*. To be presented at the National Environment and Recreation Research Symposium, March 28-31, 2026. Virginia Beach, Virginia, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.** & Rice, W.L. (2026). *Pedal-assist and pushback: How technology contributes to norm development*. To be presented at the National Environment and Recreation Research Symposium, March 28-31, 2026. Virginia Beach, Virginia, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.**, Rice, W.L., & Armatas, C.A. (2025). *Visitor preferences regarding allocation of day-use wilderness permits in two national forests*. Presented at the George Wright Society ParkForum, October 20-23, 2025. Missoula, Montana, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.** & Rice, W.L. (2025). *“It’s about the bike, not the rider”: Expressed identities and perspectives on e-bike reclassification*. Presented at the George Wright Society ParkForum, October 20-23, 2025. Missoula, Montana, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.** (2025). *Electrifying perspectives: Cyclist perspectives concerning e-bikes on multi-use singletrack*. Presented at the George Wright Society ParkForum, October 20-23, 2025. Missoula, Montana, USA.
- Johnson, H. A., Rice, W.L., **Fuesler, A.**, & Vergara, A. (2025). *Balancing access and equity: Visitor preferences for recreation rationing across wildland settings*. Presented at the International Association for Society and Natural Resources Conference, June 8-12, 2025. Vancouver, British Columbia, CAN.

- **Fuesler, A.**, Rice, W. L., Phillips, K. E., Armatas, C. A., Pitas, N. A., & Zou, S. (2025). *Translational recreation research for a more equitable outdoors: A case study in recreation allocation*. Presented at the National Environment and Recreation Research Symposium, March 30- April 1, 2025. Virginia Beach, Virginia, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.**, Bobilya, A. J., Daniel, B., & Hobbs, W. (2024). *The life significance of undergraduate outdoor academic programs: Alumni perspectives*. Presented at the Symposium for Experiential Education Research, November 14-16, 2024. Estes Park, Colorado, USA.

Refereed Poster Presentations

- **Fuesler, A.**, Rice, W.L., Armatas, C.A., Townley, E. (2026). *Applying a new allocation framework in a National Forest*. To be presented at the National Outdoor Recreation Conference, May 11-14, 2026. Duluth, Minnesota, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.**, Bobilya, A. J., Daniel, B., & Hobbs, W. (2026). *Alumni perspectives on outdoor academic program curriculum and transferability*. Presented at the National Environment and Recreation Research Symposium, March 28-31, 2026. Virginia Beach, Virginia, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.**, Rice, W.L., Armatas, C.A. (2026). *Designing a data-driven permit system for two popular, urban-proximate trailheads*. Presented at the University of Montana Graduate Research Conference, March 6, 2026. Missoula, Montana, USA. <https://scholarworks.umt.edu/gsrc/2026/posters/4/>
- **Fuesler, A.**, Bobilya, A. J., Daniel, B., & Hobbs, W. (2025). *Alumni perspectives of outdoor academic program components*. Presented at the University of Montana Graduate Research Conference, March 7, 2025. Missoula, Montana, USA. <https://scholarworks.umt.edu/gsrc/2025/posters/4/>
- **Fuesler, A.**, Bobilya, A. J., Daniel, B., & Hobbs, W. (2025). *Exploring alumni perspectives of the significance of outdoor academic program components*. Presented at The Academy of Leisure Science Research and Teaching Conference, March 5-7, 2025. Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, USA.

Invited Presentations

- **Fuesler, A.**, Rice, W.L., Townley, E., & Rushing, J.R. (2026, July). *Allocation alligators: The recreation sensation sweeping the nation!*. Presentation hosted by the Interagency Visitor Use Management Council, virtual.
- **Fuesler, A.** (2026, May). *Designing a rationing system*. Presented at the Balancing Access and Impact: Strategies for Managing Recreation Use U.S. Forest Service Training. Ramona, California, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.** (2026, May). *Booking windows*. Presented at the Balancing Access and Impact: Strategies for Managing Recreation Use U.S. Forest Service Training. Ramona, California, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.**, Rice, W.L., Townley, E., & Armatas, C.A. (2026, May). *We're back, baby!*. Presentation hosted by the U.S. Forest Service Rivers and Planning Interdisciplinary Discussions (RAPIDs) series, virtual.
- **Fuesler, A.** (2026, April). *Research and collaboration at Marshall Mountain Park*. Presented at the Montana Trails, Recreation, and Parks Association Annual Conference, March 30-April 2, 2026. Missoula, Montana, USA.
- Rice, W. L. & **Fuesler, A.** (2025, June). *Visitor capacity allocation framework for rivers, trails, and wilderness*. Presented at the Society of Outdoor Recreation Professionals Visitor Use Management Training and Symposium. Vancouver, Washington, USA.

Conference Workshops

- **Fuesler, A.** (2026). *Trends and issues in recreation research discussion*. To be presented at the Western Association of Recreation Research Professionals. October 10-13, 2026. Island Park, Idaho, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.** & Nelms, N. (2025). *Local, affordable, and accessible experiences: The importance of microadventures as place-based education*. Presented at the International Association for Experiential Education International Conference. November 6-8, 2025. Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, USA.

- **Fuesler, A.** & Goodwin, D. (2025). *The experiential-est staff training yet: Crowdsourcing the refresh you've been hoping for!*. Presented at the International Association for Experiential Education International Conference. November 6-8, 2025. Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.**, Lee, J., & Phillips, S. (2025). *Field trip to Marshall Mountain Park*. Presented at the George Wright Society ParkForum. October 20-23, 2025. Missoula, Montana, USA.
- Johnson, H. A., Rice, W.L., & **Fuesler, A.** (2025). *Taking stock during a watershed moment in recreation allocation*. Presented at the George Wright Society ParkForum. October 20-23, 2025. Missoula, Montana, USA.
- Parkinson, C., **Fuesler, A.**, Henry, C. M. (2025). *Applying cyclist behavior and backgrounds to inform e-bike policy on public lands*. To be presented at the George Wright Society ParkForum. October 20-23, 2025. Missoula, Montana, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.** (2024). *Adventurous learning: Pedagogy for a changing world*. Presented at Brevard College's Faculty Development. May 13-15, 2025. Brevard, North Carolina, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.** & Young, C. (2024). *"Bro is that an e-bike?": The intersection of e-bikes and masculinity*. Presented at the International Conference on Outdoor Leadership. February 7-9, 2024. Black Mountain, North Carolina, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.** & Young, C. (2023). *"Bro is that an e-bike?": The intersection of e-bikes and masculinity*. Presented at the Association for Experiential Education International Conference. November 7-9, 2023. Madison, Wisconsin, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.** (2021). *Learn your leadership style with No-Doze*. Presented at the 28th Annual Southeastern Adventure Education Conference. November, 2021. Black Mountain, North Carolina, USA.
- Kafsky, J.E., **Fuesler, A.**, Brown, M.A., & Chaump, K. (2019). *Voice of the Rivers: Exploration of the Cape Fear watershed*. Presented to the Transylvania Natural Resources Council. May 2019. Brevard, North Carolina, USA.
- **Fuesler, A.** & Kerr, S. (2018). *Voice of the Rivers: Exploration of the Cape Fear watershed*. Presented at the 26th Annual Southeastern Adventure Education Conference. November 2018. Asheville, North Carolina, USA.

Training Materials

- Rice, W. L., Townley, E., Armatas, C.A., **Fuesler, A.**, & Rushing, J.F. (In review). *Allocation Design Workbook*. Missoula, MT.
- **Fuesler, A.** (2019). *Teen Leader Program Coordinator Manual*. Cambria, CA: Teen Leader Program, Camp Ocean Pines. https://drive.google.com/file/d/1Qqs31V2ydeMUG4Ckt9m1fERFVV__dhvg/view?usp=sharing

Grants

- American Doctoral Fellowship, American Association of University Women. One year of funding for dissertation research, including data analysis and manuscript writing. \$25,000. September 2026. PI. Applied.
- Development Grant, She Sends Foundation. Developing Slow Spokes free gear checkout library, including bikepacking bags and two bikes. \$5,000. March 2026. PI. Applied.
- Dr. Nina Roberts Social Justice Micro-Grant, Association for Experiential Education. Purchase of one reusable disposable camera to use for an affinity group photovoice research project. \$100. February 2026. PI. Awarded.
- Missoula County Parks & Recreation, Follow-Up Visitor Use Management Study for Spring, Summer, and Fall. Completing a recreation conflict, e-bike, and visual communications study at Marshall Mountain Park. \$25,000. February 2026. Applied.
- Bureau of Land Management's National Conservation Lands, Management Studies Support Program. Completing a visitor use study of the Lower Blackfoot River Recreation Corridor. \$39,999. July 2025. Co-PI. Applied.
- National Science Foundation Innovation Program, Blackstone Lab at the University of Montana. Supporting professional development through attendance at four conferences and trainings. \$5,000. October 2024. PI. Awarded.
- Western Carolina University, Graduate Student Association Travel Grant. Facilitating a presentation at an international conference. \$800. February 2023. PI. Awarded.
- Western Carolina University, Graduate Student Association. Facilitating a presentation at an international conference. \$800. October 2022. PI. Awarded.

Scholarships and Awards

• Research 2 Impact Fellowship, Blackstone Charitable Foundation	2026
• University of Montana Doctoral Fellowship Fund	2026
• W.A. Franke Scholarship Fund, University of Montana Foundation	2026
• Greene & Smith Women's, Gender, and Sexuality Studies Scholarship, University of Montana	2026
• Loren Kreck – Edwin Fields Wilderness Scholarship, North Fork Preservation Association	2025
• W.A. Franke Scholarship Fund, University of Montana Foundation	2025
• Experiential Learning Scholarship Fund, University of Montana	2025
• Half Tuition Scholarship Recipient, Western Carolina University, Experiential & Outdoor Education Program	2022
• Community Leadership Award, Brevard College, Wilderness Leadership & Experiential Education Program	2020
• Outstanding Junior of the Year, Brevard College	2018
• Campus Leadership Award, Brevard College, Wilderness Leadership & Experiential Education Program	2018
• National Conference for College Women Student Leaders, American Association of University Women	2018

Research Interests and Current Scholarship

- Visitor preferences regarding allocation strategies in federally protected parks and wildlands.
- Recreation conflict and co-existence in multi-use areas.
- Understanding how mountain bikers perceive pedal-assist electric mountain bikes.
- Eco-pedagogy and microadventures: Cultivating place attachment in students as an antidote to climate despair.
- Social construction of outdoor adventure sports.
- Alumni perceptions of undergraduate outdoor academic program curriculum.

Service Leadership

• Western Association of Recreation Research Professionals - Planning Team Lead	2026-Present
• Crossword Puzzle 16k - Leadership Team	2026-Present
• Association of Experiential Education - Northwest Regional Advisory Council, Montana / Idaho Rep	2026-Present
• Slow Spokes Bikepacking Group - Ride Leader	2026-Present
• Association of Experiential Education - International Conference Planning Committee	2026-Present
• Slow Spokes Bikepacking Group - Finance Committee	2025-Present
• Association of Experiential Education - Scholarship Committee Reviewer	2025-Present
• University of Montana - Graduate Student Research Council & GradCon Planning Team	2024-Present
• Association of Experiential Education - Awards Committee Chair	2024-2026
• George Wright Society - Symposium Planning Committee	2024-2025
• Transylvania Adult Soccer Association - Founding Treasurer and Board Member	2023-2024
• Western Carolina University - Chancellor's Strategic Plan Committee, Academic Subcommittee	2023- 2024
• Western Carolina University - Graduate Student Association Vice President for Finance and Travel	2023- 2024
• Pisgah Area Southern Off-Road Bicycle Association - Secretary and Board Member	2023-2024
• Pisgah Area Southern Off-Road Bicycle Association - Events Chair and Board Member	2021-2023
• Emerging Professionals in Camping American Camp Association - North Carolina Representative	2021-2022
• United Methodist Camp and Retreat Ministries Association - Board Member	2017-2021
• Transylvania County Democratic Party - Volunteer Coordinator	2020-2021
• Outdoor Ministries Connection Great Gathering - Intern	2019
• Brevard College - Institute of Women in Leadership Steering Committee	2018-2019
• Brevard College - Student Governing Association Treasurer	2018-2019
• Brevard College - Dimensions Math Club Treasurer	2018-2019
• Brevard College - Outing Club Executive Board President	2017-2019

- Brevard College - Institute of Women in Leadership 2017-2019
 - Brevard College - Tight Knit Club Co-Founder and Secretary 2017-2018
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Completed Peer Reviews

Journals

- Journal of Experiential Education (3)
- Journal of Outdoor Recreation and Tourism (3)
- Journal of Outdoor Recreation, Education, & Leadership (2)
- Journal of Park and Recreation Administration (2)
- Journal of Environmental Management (1)

Conference Abstracts

- George Wright Society ParkForum (2025)
 - Graduate Student Research and Scholarship Conference at the University of Montana (2025)
 - Symposium for Experiential Education Research (2025)
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Professional Associations

- Philanthropic Education Organization, BQ Chapter since 2026
 - Association of Experiential Education Member since 2024
 - Leave No Trace Member since 2023
 - Omicron Delta Kappa Honor Society Member since 2023
 - International Mountain Bike Association Member 2021-2026
 - American Association of University Women since 2018
 - United Methodist Camp and Retreat Ministry Association 2017-2021
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Professional Certifications & Trainings

- Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act: Collaborative Institute Training Initiative since 2026
 - Universal Design for Learning Training: Environmental Educators of North Carolina since 2025
 - Behavioral First Responder Level 2: Alpenglow Institute since 2024
 - Justice, Equity, Diversity, & Inclusion Training: Environmental Educators of North Carolina 2024
 - Human Subjects Research Ethics Training: Collaborative Institute Training Initiative since 2023
 - North Carolina Environmental Educator Certificate since 2023
 - Outdoor Leader Training Course: Wilderness Education Association 2023
 - Leave No Trace Level 2 Instructor: Leave No Trace since 2023
 - Wilderness First Responder: NOLS since 2022
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Teaching Experience

Brevard College

Facilitator

Facilitated a two-day workshop for twenty faculty and staff as they developed lesson plans and extracurricular activities devoted to vocational development in undergraduate students at a liberal arts college. Summer 2026

United States Forest Service

Facilitator

Developed, coordinated, and instructed a three-day workshop for twenty-five land managers as they learned the basics of recreation allocation and designed an allocation system for a high-visitation area. Summer 2026

University of Montana*Instructor*

PTRM 210: Nature Tourism & Commercial Recreation, Fall 2026

Teaching Assistant:

PTRM 217: Parks and Outdoor Recreation Management, Spring 2026

PTRM 300: Recreation Behavior, Spring 2026

Guest Lecturer

GPHY 385: Field Techniques, Fall 2025

Western Carolina University*Guest Lecturer*

PRM 493: Conference Planning, Fall 2023

Camp Pinnacle*Program Director*

Developed and instructed the seasonal staff training for eighty seasonal staff members, with lessons focused on feedback, growth mindset, Tuckman's Theory of Group Development, communication, risk management, teaching and engagement strategies, lesson planning, and programming. Summer 2021

Brevard College*Co-Instructor*

WLE 220: Theory & Practice of Experiential Education, Spring 2022

ILO 213: Sacred Ritual and Music in Sacred Spaces, Fall 2022*

Guest Lecturer

WLE 405: Senior Seminar in Wilderness Leadership & Experiential Education, Fall 2023

WLE 220: Theory & Practice of Experiential Education, Spring 2019, Fall 2020

Teaching Assistant

IWIL 101: Finding Your Voice - Institute for Women in Leadership, Fall 2019*

WLE 220: Theory & Practice of Experiential Education, Fall 2018

FYE 101H: First-Year Experience, Fall 2018, Fall 2019

Montreat College*Guest Lecturer*

OREC 3420: Conference and Event Planning, Spring 2020

Camp Ocean Pines*Counselor-in-Training Program Coordinator*

Developed, instructed, and oversaw the entire Counselor-in-Training Program for four camp sessions, serving ten students at a time.

* Indicates Travel Course.

Selected Professional Experience

Wildland and Recreation Management Lab at the University of Montana

Missoula, MT

Research Assistant

Aug 2024-Present

- Design a training program for United States Forest Service employees to learn how to design efficient and fair allocation systems.
- Provide data-driven support to a local, county-administered trail system in refining its e-bike policy.

Brevard College

Brevard, NC

Executive Assistant to the VP of Academic Affairs & Dean of Faculty

Jan 2023-Jul 2024

- Organize and execute hiring process for full-time and adjunct faculty, including organizing interviews, collecting resumes, and generating contracts
- Facilitate event planning related to faculty meetings, faculty development training, Convocation, Baccalaureate, and Commencement ceremonies

Experiential Learning Program Assistant

Jan 2022-Jan 2023

- Support program logistical needs, including assisting with classroom and office needs, logistics of field experiences, guest speakers, and community events.
- Manage program expenses (i.e., budget tracking, purchase requisitions, invoices, check requests, monthly reconciliation reports) and maintain expense reports for each program.
- Process Intensive Learning Opportunity course concept and final proposal approvals for faculty. Execute specifics of each request, including transportation, meals, admission fees, and honorariums, as appropriate.

Camp Pinnacle

Flat Rock, NC

Assistant Director

Aug 2021-May 2022

- Assist in the organization and coordination of all summer programming
- Manage in the hiring pipeline, including interviews, hiring paperwork, and training, for summer and year-round staff

Program Director

Jan 2021-Aug 2021

- Organize daily and weekly schedules for staff and twenty cabins for nine weeks of camp programming
- Manage parent and family relations, including forms and document tracking, office-to-parent communication, and general customer service